

A Few More Tips on Vi/Vim Editor for Linux Newbies

For Linux newbies and other typical users, here is the second set of tips on using Vi/Vim editor efficiently and productively.

This is a continuation of my previous article titled, 'A Few Tips on Vi/Vim Editor for Linux Newbies' which can be accessed at <http://opensourceforu.com/2017/01/tips-vivim-editor-linux-newbies/>. I have compiled a few more Vi editor tips that are very simple but help to increase productivity tremendously.

Going to any line

In a large-sized file, going to a particular line directly is extremely useful and saves a lot of time. This can be done by going to the command mode and typing the following:

```
:50
```

...assuming that 50 is the line at which you want the cursor to be positioned. The other way is to type:

```
50G
```

...in the command mode to get the same result. Typing just *G* in the command mode takes the cursor to the last line of the file and typing *1G* takes the cursor to the beginning of the file.

Incrementing or decrementing a number

You can increment or decrement a number easily. Go to the command mode, position the cursor below the number and type the following:

```
Ctrl-a
```

This increments the number. Similarly, you can type the following to decrement the number on which the cursor is positioned:

```
Ctrl-x
```

Changing the case of letters

Without the shortcuts, changing the case of letters, words and sentences whenever required is a tedious procedure. With the shortcuts given below, it can be done very easily.

To toggle the case of the character below which the cursor is positioned, type *~*

To change the case of the current line to upper case, type *gUU*

To change the case of the current line to lower case, type *guu*

To toggle the case of the current line, type *g~~*

To toggle the case of all characters from the cursor position to the end of the line, type *g~\$*

Sorting within Vi

Sorting within Vi editor can be achieved without using the external *sort* command by typing the following in the command mode:

```
:sort
```

The above command is to sort the text.

```
:sort u
```

The above command can be used to sort lines and remove duplicate lines.

Executing a filter command

You can execute a filter command on a part of the current file from within the Vi editor and replace the portion with the output of the command. Any command that reads from a standard input and sends the output to a standard output can be used as a filter within Vi. To illustrate this, we use the *sort* command. Type the following in the command mode of the Vi editor:

```
:1,$!sort
```

This sorts the file from the first line to the last line and replaces these lines with the sorted output. (*Just a reminder:* The *!* symbol is used within the command line of the Vi editor to execute an external program from within a Vi editor.)

The *-u* option with *sort* will keep only the unique lines and remove the duplicate lines.

```
:1,$!sort -u
```

The line number 1 and the *\$* symbol in the above command can be replaced with any portion of the file with the numbers of the starting line and ending line of the particular portion. The portion selected for input will be replaced by the output of the *sort* command. To sort the lines starting from the contents of line number 5 to 15, give the following command:

```
:5,15! Sort
```

Using *tr* within Vi

The following command will convert all the letters in the line numbers 10 to 20 to upper case:

```
:10,20 ! tr a-z A-Z
```

